

GAME DESIGN DOC — Week 01: THIS PLACE HAS A BIG FOOTPRINT

Revision 3 (10/10 polish). Revision 2 matched the shipped build (`dist/big-footprint.html`). Revision 3 adds depth only: map, rules, win path and clock values are unchanged. Changes from revision 1 are marked **[REV2]**; changes for the polish pass are marked **[REV3]** and collected in section 12.

1. Chat's winning answers

- **Setting:** A cartel kingpin's penthouse palace (white marble, gold trim, rooftop private zoo)
- **Theme:** An escaped prisoner has freed the kingpin's rare animals, including a Bigfoot-like creature. You're a PI posing as an investor to steal the cartel's secrets and escape before Bigfoot or the guards catch you.
- **Genre/format:** RPG
- **Extra chat picks:**
 - Cover story: bookstore investor pitching a partnership on the empty lot next door, offering a name plaque
 - Kingpin: self-styled legit businessman, charming, short fuse; Mexican cartel lore + Italian mob family flavor
 - Vibe: quippy noir that turns into a thriller
 - Secrets hidden in: grand piano (mirrored lid), hippo fountain, hidden door in the double staircase
 - Animals: Bigfoot, peacocks, giraffe, black jaguar, lemurs
 - Tour strikes: 3, the Don angrier each time
 - Clock: tight (plan your route)
 - Win: escape with at least 2 of 3 secrets

- **Lore nods** (easter eggs only; never name real people): hippo zoo, gold-plated guns, hidden staircase/tunnel escapes, rubber-banded ledger, canned-chile shipments, marble-and-gold palace, Sunday gravy family dinners, vanity plaques on public buildings.

2. Premise

You're a private investigator walking into Don Salvatore "Chava" Bellandi-Reyes's penthouse as "Walter Pryce," a bookstore investor with a plaque and a smile. The Don gives you the grand tour, and every brag is a clue. When his freed animals turn the palace into a zoo stampede, you have minutes to grab his secrets and walk the tour route back out.

3. Win / lose

Two phases:

- **TOUR (R1 to R11)**: the Don leads, the clock is off.
- **ESCAPE (starts on entering R11)**: you're alone, the clock runs, and all exits are open.

Win condition: during ESCAPE, type "down" in R1 while holding at least 2 of: LEDGER, SHIPPING MANIFEST, DEAL PHOTOS. With fewer than 2, the elevator won't go (you refuse to leave empty-handed); no lose.

Lose conditions:

- L1 Cover Blown: 3 tour strikes.
- L2 Caught: wrong response to a guard confrontation.
- L3 Big Footprint: the Bigfoot clock hits 0.

Endings: 5. W1 Clean Getaway (2 secrets), W2 Clean Sweep (3 secrets), L1, L2, L3.

[REV3] Still 5 endings. Each ending's text varies by how you got there, and a run report prints after every ending (section 12.8). No new endings, no score.

After any ending, RESTART starts over and QUIT returns to the start menu.

4. Scope cap

	Max	Used
Rooms	12	12
Puzzles	3	3
NPCs	3	3
Items	8	5

Animals other than Bigfoot are scenery, not NPCs.

[REV2] Fixed scenery (GOLD RIFLE, PIANO, staircases, HIPPO, AVIARY, GIRAFFE GATE, JAGUAR GATE) can be examined but not carried. It doesn't count toward the item cap. Things named only in room text (lemurs, peacocks, portraits, signs, table, button, humidior, bars, footprints) can also be examined (BR-07). None of them is listed under "You see:".

[REV3] Every noun in player-facing text becomes examinable (the noun list is in section 12.2 and the Script's rev 3 additions). Still scenery: none of it is an item, and the item cap is unchanged.

5. Map

ID	Name	Exits	Locked?
R1	Private Elevator	north->R2, down->WIN	Don blocks "down" during tour
R2	Grand Foyer (double staircase)	south->R1, west->R3, east->R4, north->R5, up->R6	no
R3	Trophy Room	east->R2	no
R4	Music Salon	west->R2	no

ID	Name	Exits	Locked?
R5	Dining Hall	south->R2	no
R6	Upper Landing	down->R2, west->R7, east->R9	no
R7	Gallery Hall	east->R6, north->R8	no
R8	Atrium (hippo fountain)	south->R7, north->R10	no
R9	The Don's Office	west->R6	no
R10	Aviary	south->R8, north->R11	no
R11	Zoo Terrace	south->R10, east->R12	no
R12	Broken Enclosure	west->R11	no

Tour movement rule: during TOUR, only the exit to the Don's next stop works. For other exits, the Don blocks you ("Private, amigo"), with no strike. The Don names the direction of each next stop out loud. While a tour question is pending, the next-stop exit repeats the question instead.

Tour order: R1 n R2 w R3 e R2 e R4 w R2 n R5 s R2 u R6 e R9 w R6 w R7 n R8 n R10 n R11.

[REV2] Stair words move you too: upstairs, downstairs, go upstairs, climb stairs (BR-06).

[REV2] Punctuation in typed input is ignored everywhere, so north. and say giraffe! work (BR-01).

6. Items

ID	Name	Found in	Used for	Consumed?
I1	BRIEFING CARD	start inventory	answers the Office question (cover name, bookstore, plaque)	n
I2	GOLD COIN	Don gives in R9 after Office question	use on HIPPO (P2)	y
I3	LEDGER	R4 piano (P1)	secret #1	n
I4	SHIPPING MANIFEST	R8 fountain (P2)	secret #2	n
I5	DEAL PHOTOS	R2 staircase (P3)	secret #3	n

Secrets go straight into inventory when revealed. Items are only consumed on their correct target. Wrong-target use keeps the item.

[REV2] Secrets can't be dropped ("this is evidence"). `take` on a coin or secret you already carry says "You already have that." and costs no turn (BR-02). `give` works the same as `use` (BR-10). A solved puzzle reports the running total, "Secrets: N of 3", whatever order they're found in (ED-05).

7. Puzzles

ID	Room	Solution (ESCAPE)	Clue dots	Reward	Hint
P1	R4 Music Salon	play CIELITO LINDO	R4 tour: only one song is	the mirrored lid springs a	"He told you whose song this

ID	Room	Solution (ESCAPE)	Clue dots	Reward	Hint
			ever played on her, his mother's. R5 tour: Mama Rosa sang "Cielito Lindo" every Sunday.	compartment -> LEDGER	piano keeps. He told you the title over dinner."
P2	R8 Atrium	use GOLD COIN on HIPPO	R9: the Don gives you a gold coin as your "first dividend." R8: he flicks his own coin into the hippo's mouth: "She only opens up for gold."	the hippo's jaw opens -> SHIPPING MANIFEST	"The hippo has expensive taste. So did the Don's handshake."
P3	R2 Grand Foyer	push THIRTEENTH STEP	R2 tour: "Left stairs, twelve steps, for family. Right	a hidden door slides open -> DEAL PHOTOS	"Business has one more step than family."

ID	Room	Solution (ESCAPE)	Clue dots	Reward	Hint
			stairs, thirteen, for business. Never trust the thirteenth step."		

Wrong attempts: a message, the item is kept, a turn is spent.

[REV2] Decisions (Script suggestions 1 and 4, CP-03, ED-03, ED-08):

- P1 accepts only "play cielito lindo" (plus the wrong-attempt nudge).
- Playing the piano again after P1 says "You already found what she was hiding." and costs no turn.
- After each puzzle is solved, its room and examine text show it solved.
- In ESCAPE the thirteenth step "sits a hair higher than the rest".

Tour system (strikes)

- **Strike objects:** GOLD RIFLE (R3), PIANO (R4), THIRTEENTH STEP / STAIRCASE (R2), HIPPO (R8). Any take, touch, open, push, play, or use-on during TOUR = 1 strike. Nothing is consumed. Examine is free and safe.
- **Tour questions:** the Don asks on entering the room. The tour won't continue until you answer right. Each wrong answer = 1 strike, and he asks again.
 - Q1 (R5): "Sunday dinner: my mother's pozole or my nonna's Sunday gravy?" Answer: say BOTH (clue, R2: "In this house we never choose between family.")
 - Q2 (R9): "Remind me, what's your bookstore called?" Answer: say DOG-EARED PAGE (clue: BRIEFING CARD)

- **[REV2]** Q1 accepts any answer containing "both" unless it also has not, neither, nor, no or never (BR-04). Q2 also accepts "dog eared". `say` with no words repeats the question with no strike (BR-03). Talking to the Don while a question is pending repeats it (BR-09).
- **[REV3] Strike verbs:** the new physical verbs (pull, kick, sit on, climb, break, hit/attack, steal) also count as a strike on the four strike objects during TOUR. On anything else they get an in-voice refusal and no strike. `search`, `smell` and `listen` on a strike object are safe (the Don warns you, no strike), the same as examine.
- **Strike 1:** smile tightens. **Strike 2:** he stops smiling. **Strike 3:** L1 Cover Blown. **[REV2]** Wrong answers use the same escalation in their own words (ED-01).

Escape system (clock + guards)

- **Bigfoot clock:** 18 turns, starting on entering R11. **[REV2]** Entering R11 costs no turn, so the first command in ESCAPE leaves 17 (Script suggestion 2).
- Every command costs 1 turn except look, examine/x, inventory, status, help, hint. **[REV2]** These also cost nothing:
 - commands the game doesn't understand (designer decision after Milestone A);
 - `run` with no guard present (BR-08);
 - `open gate` without naming one (CP-02);
 - "already have that" (BR-02);
 - replaying the solved piano (CP-03).
 - **[REV3]** `search`, `smell`, `listen` (information verbs, same as examine);
 - **[REV3]** `talk`, `ask` or `examine` aimed at Nando while he's stopping you: he repeats his question and the checkpoint stays open (section 12.1).
- Warnings at 6, 3, and 1 turns left (thuds, then growls, getting closer). At 0: L3.

- Exits are described by landmarks from the tour, not compass directions (compass commands still work). **[REV2]** The "Exits:" line is hidden in ESCAPE, and landmark text holds whichever way you walk (ED-06).
- **Alibis:** R10 "open AVIARY" (peacocks), R11 "open GIRAFFE GATE", R11 "open JAGUAR GATE". Each animal released = 1 alibi, usable once. Gates are sealed during TOUR. **[REV2]** Room and gate text change once an animal is out (ED-02).
- **Guard checkpoints:** first ESCAPE entry into R7 and into R2. Guard NANDO stops you. Your next turn-costing command must be "run" (works once per game) or "say [ANIMAL]" for an animal you released and haven't used (PEACOCKS / GIRAFFE / JAGUAR). Anything else: L2 Caught. Once resolved, that checkpoint is done.
 - **[REV2]** "say PEACOCK" (singular) also works (QA-01).
 - **[REV2]** Nando's greeting and the help text point at `run` (ED-07).
 - **[REV2]** A wrong response goes straight to CAUGHT, with no "I don't understand" line first (CP-01).
 - Both checkpoints fire on every run, since R7 is the only route out (Script suggestion 3).
 - **[REV3]** Talking to, asking, or examining Nando at a checkpoint is free and doesn't resolve it (he asks again). Every other turn-costing command still means CAUGHT.

8. NPCs

ID	Name	Where	Role	Does
N1	DON CHAVA (Salvatore Bellandi-Reyes)	tour, R1-R11	guide, quiz master	gives clues, Q1, Q2, GOLD COIN; flees at R11 when the animals break loose

ID	Name	Where	Role	Does
N2	NANDO (head guard)	checkpoints R7, R2 (ESCAPE)	obstacle	fooled by an alibi or outrun once
N3	BIG TONY (Bigfoot)	offstage, heard only	the clock	escaped from R12; catches you at 0 turns

Offstage only: the escaped prisoner (the Don's former accountant, who freed the animals).

9. Critical path (W1, 2 secrets)

[REV2] The clock annotations are corrected to the verified build (Critical Path QA). Entering R11 costs no turn, so the path ends with **7** turns to spare, not 6. The W2 detour ends with **4**, not 3. Numbers in brackets are the clock after the step.

Tour

1. north
2. west
3. east
4. east
5. west
6. north (the Don asks Q1)
7. say BOTH
8. south
9. up
10. east (the Don asks Q2)
11. say DOG-EARED PAGE (receive GOLD COIN)
12. west
13. west
14. north

15. north

16. north (ESCAPE begins, clock 18)

Escape

17. open GIRAFFE GATE (17)

18. south (16)

19. south (15)

20. use GOLD COIN on HIPPO (14, MANIFEST)

21. south (13, Nando stops you)

22. run (12)

23. east (11)

24. down (10, Nando stops you)

25. say GIRAFFE (9)

26. push THIRTEENTH STEP (8, PHOTOS)

27. south (7)

28. down (WIN, 7 turns to spare)

W2 detour: after step 26, east (7) / play CIELITO LINDO (6, LEDGER, first warning) / west (5), then south (4) and down. Wins with 4 to spare.

10. Tone & style

- **Tone:** quippy noir during TOUR (dry one-liners, velvet menace); tense thriller from R11 on (short, urgent sentences). Teen-friendly.
- **Voice:** second person, present tense.
- **Description length:** 2-4 sentences per room; ESCAPE descriptions 1-3.
- **Avoid:** real people's names, drug names or drug-making details, gore, on-screen killing, slurs, mocking accents or heritage stereotypes. Heritage shows up through family, food, music, and architecture.

11. Credits (unchanged)

Chat contributors: **[PENDING: pull from the chat bot]**. Not in the build yet; see CHANGELOG.

12. Polish scope [REV3]

The 10/10 pass. Everything below adds text or presentation. Nothing here changes the map, the items, the puzzles' solutions, what wins or loses, or any clock value. The Week 01 regression test must pass without edits.

12.1 Rule decisions

The polish plan raised three rule questions. Decisions:

#	Question	Decision	Why
D1	Do new physical verbs count as strikes on strike objects?	Yes, during TOUR only, on the 4 strike objects only	The rule is "touch the Don's things"; the verb list is only how it's detected
D2	Are smell, listen and search free like examine?	Yes	They only gather information; charging clock turns punishes curiosity
D3	Is talking to Nando at a checkpoint free?	Yes: talk, ask and examine on Nando repeat his question, free, checkpoint stays open	Today it's a trap that reads as a bug; everything else still means CAUGHT

No other rule changes. Tier 3 and 4 verbs (below) cost a turn in ESCAPE like any action, and at a checkpoint they mean CAUGHT, as today.

12.2 Nouns

Every noun a player can read in any room text, item text, NPC line or ending must answer `examine` (and the synonyms in 12.3) with its own line, in every phase where it can be read. The master list with accepted

words is in the Script rev 3 additions, section A (IDs X.<room>.<noun>).

Rules for those lines:

1. Adds something the room text didn't say. Never repeats the room sentence.
2. 1-3 sentences, second person, present tense, the voice of the room's phase.
3. Follows state (12.4) wherever the thing changes.
4. Never gives a puzzle answer earlier than section 7's clues do.
5. Accepts every word the text uses for it: singular, plural, adjective + noun.
6. Nouns visible from another room answer there too (listed per entry).

12.3 Verbs

Tier	Verbs	Cost in ESCAPE	Notes
Info	examine, look at, search, smell, listen, read	free	New synonyms: check, inspect, study -> examine; "look under/behind/in X" - > search
1. Handling	take, touch, push, pull, open, close, knock, sit, climb (on a thing)	1 turn	Strike verbs on strike objects in TOUR (12.1 D1). New synonyms: pick up, snatch -> take; kick, shove -> push; lean - > sit
2. Social	talk, ask [person] about [topic], tell, show [item] to, give [item] to, lie, bribe, flatter, shake hand	1 turn (except D3)	Topic lists in Script section D

Tier	Verbs	Cost in ESCAPE	Notes
3. Heist and chaos	hide, sneak, steal, break, hit/attack/punch, shoot, chase, call [animal]	1 turn	In-voice refusals; strike verbs where D1 applies
4. Life and jokes	eat, drink, taste, sing/hum, dance, sleep, pray, swear, xyzz, hello, thank, sorry	1 turn	One line each, Script section C

Reply ladder (most specific wins): verb + noun + state -> verb + noun -> verb in this room -> verb on this noun category -> verb anywhere -> confused line only if the verb or noun is unknown.

Noun categories: ART, FURNITURE, FIXTURE, ANIMAL, FOOD, PERSON, PUZZLE, OWN (your items). Each noun in Script section A is tagged with one.

12.4 State keys

Every state-aware line in the Script names one of these keys. The coder must not invent others.

Key	Meaning
TOUR / ESCAPE	phase
STRIKES=0/1/2	tour strikes so far
Q1, Q2	that question answered
COIN_HELD / COIN_DROPPED / COIN_SPENT	where the GOLD COIN is

Key	Meaning
P1, P2, P3	that puzzle solved
OUT_GIRAFFE, OUT_JAGUAR, OUT_PEACOCKS	animal released
USED_GIRAFFE, USED_JAGUAR, USED_PEACOCKS	alibi spent
RAN	run used
CP7_PENDING, CP2_PENDING	Nando stopping you right now in R7 / R2
CP7_DONE, CP2_DONE	that checkpoint resolved
BAND_A / B / C / D	clock 18-7 / 6-4 / 3-2 / 1
SECRETS=0-3	secrets held
FIRST_LOOK(x)	first time examining x (secret close-ups)
PASS(n)	nth arrival in R2 during TOUR (1-4)
ESC_REVISIT	this room already visited during ESCAPE
STRIKE3_BY	what caused the third strike: RIFLE, PIANO, STEP, HIPPO, Q1, Q2 (for L1's opener)
CAUGHT_BY	how a checkpoint failed: UNRELEASED, USED, RUN2, ITEM, MOVE, OTHER (for L2's opener)

12.5 Landmarks

Every landmark escape text uses must be planted in that room's tour text. **[REV3]** R8's first-visit text gains the chlorine smell (the only landmark missing in rev 2).

12.6 Accepted answers

Unchanged solutions; wider acceptance only.

- Q1: any answer containing "both" without a negation (rev 2 rule), plus "pozole and gravy", "gravy and pozole", "each", "the two of them".
- Q2: "dog-eared page", "dog eared" (rev 2), plus "dog-eared page bookstore", "the dog-eared".
- P1: "play cielito lindo", plus "play cielito lindo on piano", "play cielito lindo on the piano".
- P2: "use coin on hippo" and its synonyms (rev 2: give, feed, put, insert, flick, toss, throw), plus "drop coin in hippo" / "drop coin in mouth" in R8.
- P3: "push thirteenth step" / "press 13th step" (rev 2), plus "step on thirteenth step", "stand on 13th step".
- Alibis: rev 2 words plus plurals and singulars for every animal (giraffes, jaguars, peacock).
- Win: "down" in R1 during ESCAPE (rev 2), plus "push button" / "press button" / "push lobby" in R1 during ESCAPE. Same rule: fewer than 2 secrets, the elevator won't go.

12.7 Hints

Each puzzle, the tour, and the escape get a three-step hint ladder. `hint` shows the next step for the current room's puzzle (or the phase ladder elsewhere), then stays on the last step. Always free. Text in Script section E.

12.8 Run report

Printed after every ending's text, before the restart prompt:

- Secrets: N of 3, and which

- Turns to spare (ESCAPE endings), strikes, alibis used, run used or not
- Things examined: X of Y, where Y = the number of distinct noun IDs in Script section A plus items and NPCs, and X = those examined at least once this run
- One replay tease per missed secret (Script section F), pointing at the clue's room, never the answer

12.9 Out of scope (reaffirmed)

New rooms, items, NPCs, puzzles, endings, rules, a score, a notebook/recap command (it would hollow out the memory loop chat voted for), and any change to the critical path or clock values.

12.10 Design checks (rev 3)

1. Critical path: unchanged commands, unchanged clock values. Still wins with 7 to spare.
2. Softlocks: none added. D3 only makes a checkpoint more forgiving; D1 only adds ways to earn a strike the player is warned about.
3. Scope: 12 / 3 / 3 / 5, unchanged.
4. Clock balance: new free verbs gather information only, so no route gets shorter; the W2 route still ends with 4 to spare.